



Course Handout (Part II)

Dated: 01-08-26

In addition to Part-I (General Handout for all courses appended to the time table) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course No: **HSS F343**

Course Title: **Professional Ethics**

Instructor-in-charge: **Anupam Yadav**

6168R, New Academic Building

1. Course Description

An introduction to the ethical concepts, theories, and codes that govern professional life. The course traces the foundations of ethics and the profession, before applying this framework across business, management, education, engineering, and computing.

2. Scope & Objective:

This course provides a formal acquaintance with the concepts and frameworks of ethics; recognize the codes of ethics relevant to the experience of being a professional and develops an understanding of the ethical issues relating to professions generally, and to business, management, education, engineering, and computing in particular. Through the analysis of real-time case studies, students learn to appreciate the role of moral reasoning in issues of professional life.

3. Course Learning Objectives:

Upon completion of the course students will have

- An understanding of the core concepts of ethics, the profession, and professional ethics, and their specific application across business, management, education, engineering, and computing.
- A critical and comparative grasp of competing ethical theories and professional viewpoints such as rule-following versus professional judgment.
- An ability to apply ethical theories and frameworks to real, contested professional dilemmas, extending this reasoning across multiple professional domains rather than any single one.
- An ability to practice the habit of sound ethical judgment and professional responsibility in one's own future career and conduct.

4. Text Book:

John R. Boatright, Jeffery D. Smith & Bibhu Prasan Patra, Ethics and the Conduct of Business, Pearson Education, Eighth Edition, Indian Edition, 2018

Reference books:

Rowan, John, and Zinaich, Jr., Ethics for the Professions, Wadsworth, 2003

Peter Singer, A Companion to Ethics, Oxford: Blackwell Publishers, 1993



Richard Norman, The Moral Philosophers: An Introduction to Ethics, Oxford University Press, 1998

Sekhar, R.V.R.A., Ethics and Indian Philosophy (or equivalent reference as specified by instructor)

5. Course Plan (Modulewise):

Module Number	Lecture Session	Reference	Learning Outcome
1. Foundations of Ethics, the Profession, and Professional Ethics	1.1 Ethics, Applied Ethics and Professional Ethics	Text Book, Ch. 1; Rowan, Introduction	Learning about the nature and applications of ethics; the distinct meaning of a profession and enabling the students to learn about the vital role of ethics in professions and across professional domains
	1.2 Concept of a Profession	Rowan, Introduction	
	1.3 Ethics and Professions	Text Book, Ch. 1; Rowan, Ch. 2	
	1.4 Across the Professions	Rowan, Introduction; Ch. 4	
2. Ethical Theories	2.1 Ethical Theories	Text Book, Ch. 2 Rowan, Ch. 1	Comprehending the nature and role of ethical theories in the form of different approaches to ethics; understanding the value of duty to respect the moral law in rightful doing; learning the nature and value of general happiness in rightful doing and the importance of virtues in Good Human Life and understanding the composite nature of Indian ethical thought and develop ethical reasoning.
	2.2 Deontological Theory	Text Book, Ch. 3; Rowan, Ch. 1	
	2.3 Utilitarian Theory	Text Book, Ch. 3; Rowan, Ch. 1	
	2.4 Virtue Theory	Text Book, Ch. 3; Rowan, Ch. 1	
	2.5 Indian Ethical Theory	Sekhar, Ch. 1	
3. Professional Codes and Employment Relations	3.1 - 3.2 Ethical Codes for various Professions	Text Book, Ch. 13	Comprehending the moral demands vis-à-vis the objectives and roles of different professions; understanding the moral basis of employment and the relation among professionals; learning about a peculiar moral right of a professional; appreciating the ethical nuances of women related issues in professions
	3.3 Employer-Employee Relation	Text Book, Ch. 8; Rowan, Ch. 3	
	3.4 Whistle-Blowing	Text Book, Ch. 4	
	3.5 Women and Family Issues	Rowan, Ch. 3	
	3.6 Case Studies	-	



Module Number	Lecture Session	Reference	Learning Outcome
			and analysing moral implications in concrete situations
4. Business Ethics	4.1 Business Ethics	Text Book, Ch. 1	Learning to assess the nature and value of business ethics and knowing the moral responsibilities of a business organization in a society; understanding the role of ethics in marketing and advertising and their relevance for professionals; examine the right of a professional to a safe workplace and to analyze moral implications in concrete situations
	4.2 - 4.3 Corporate Social Responsibility and Stakeholders	Text Book, Ch. 12 & Ch. 13	
	4.4 - 4.5 Marketing and Advertising	Text Book, Ch. 10	
	4.6 Occupational Health and Safety	Text Book, Ch. 9	
	4.7 Case-Studies	-	
5. Management Ethics	5.1 Management Ethics	Reference Material	Learning management ethics and its importance for professionals; knowing the value of an ethical approach in management and to assess the moral implications of discrimination and unjust dismissal in a workplace. Analysing concrete situations and their moral implications.
	5.2 Efficiency and Effectiveness	Reference Material	
	5.3 - 5.4 Discrimination and Unjust Dismissal	Text Book, Ch. 7 & Ch. 8	
	5.5 Case-Studies	-	
6. Education Ethics	6.1 Education Ethics	Rowan, Ch. 11	Comprehending the role of ethics in the field of education: the perspectives of education; the ends of education; and reflections on the ethical relation between the educator and the students and able to analyze moral implications in concrete situations.
	6.2 Educator and Educational Institution	Rowan, Ch. 11	
	6.3 Case-Studies	-	
7. Engineering Ethics	7.1 Engineering Ethics	Rowan, Ch. 6	Learning the nature of engineering ethics; making an assessment of the inter-dependence of standards and values in engineering profession; knowing about ethical practices in engineering and public interest;
	7.2 Standards and Values for Engineers	Rowan, Ch. 6	
	7.3 Engineers and Public Interest	Rowan, Ch. 6	



Module Number	Lecture Session	Reference	Learning Outcome
	7.4 Professional Information in Engineering	Rowan, Ch. 6	understanding the ethical issues concerning the use of professional information and further analysing moral implications in concrete situations.
	7.5 Case-Studies	-	
8. Computer and Information Ethics	8.1 Computer Ethics	Reference Material	Learning about the ethical impacts of computerization on society; weighing moral problems and solutions in the use of computers; analysing some peculiar moral issues raised by the use of internet and moral implications in concrete situations.
	8.2 Ethical Problems in Information and Communication	Reference Material	
	8.3 Internet and Society	Reference Material	
	8.4 Privacy, Security, and Moral Wrongdoing	Reference Material	
	8.5 Case-Studies	-	

6. Evaluation Scheme:

Component	Duration	Weightage	Date & Time	Nature of Component (Close Book / Open Book)
Assignment	-	15	To be announced.	Open Book
Mid Semester Exam	90 Minutes	30		Close Book
Case Study	50 Minutes	15	To be announced.	Open Book
Comprehensive Examination	3 Hours	40		Close Book

Attendance Policy: Each student is expected to attend all classes and participate in all evaluation components.

Chamber Consultation Hour: To be announced in the class.

Makeup Policy: Make-up components will be allowed for mid-semester and comprehensive exams provided there is a valid documentary proof to support the case.

Instructor-in-charge

HSS F343